All-In Podcast: 2026 Predictions

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⏱️ **5-Minute Version:** Watch Key Excerpts

Speaker Bios

> **Jason Calacanis** is founder of Launch and host of This Week in Startups. Angel investor (Uber, Calm, Robinhood). Known for contrarian takes and founder advocacy.

> **Chamath Palihapitiya** is founder of Social Capital. Former Facebook exec. Investor in climate tech, fintech, and healthcare. Known for macro thematic investing.

> **David Sacks** is co-founder of Craft Ventures and PayPal. Serves in Trump administration. Known for enterprise software investing and political commentary.

> **David Friedberg** is founder of The Production Board. Former Google exec and Climate Corp founder. Covers science, biotech, and prediction markets.

Executive Summary

The besties converge on **5-6% GDP growth** for 2026—Chamath calls 5% the floor, 6.2% upper bound. Atlanta Fed's GDP Now just jumped to 5.4% for Q4 2025 (from 2.7% five days prior). Productivity printed 4.9%, a 6-year high. The mechanism: closed border + AI productivity threat + tax cuts = coiled spring. Non-farm payrolls rebased from 100-150 prints to 40-50 due to immigration changes. Lower quartile earnings growth "off the charts." Ford paying mechanics $160K/year with 5,000 openings.

California wealth tax dominates—Sacks moved to Texas, Chamath scouting despite "stay and fight" rhetoric. Super-voting shares provision punitive: Sergey/Larry's ~$100B each would be deemed ~$1T each (52% voting power × $4T market cap = 25% effective tax, not 5%). If ballot measure passes, "rush for the exits"—half trillion in net worth already left. April timeline for signature gathering. Poly market at 69%.

Business winners: Copper (Chamath)—70% global supply deficit by 2040; Amazon (Jason)—first "corporate singularity" with more robots than humans; IPOs (Sacks)—trillions in new market cap; Poly Market (Friedberg)—replacing media and markets. **Business losers:** Software industrial complex (Chamath)—AI disrupting $3-4T/year maintenance/migration spend; State governments (Friedberg)—pension liabilities + waste exposure = financing problems; California (Sacks)—wealth tax + regulations.

Contrarian beliefs: AI increases knowledge worker demand via Jevons paradox (Sacks); SpaceX reverse-merges into Tesla, no IPO (Chamath); Central banks seek new cryptographic paradigm beyond Bitcoin/gold (Chamath); US-China standoff largely resolved (Jason). **Tech as political loser**—fracturing on both left (alignment backlash) and right (censorship grudge); Friedberg spoke with senators who view certain tech leaders as "not trustworthy."

Listen or Skip?

Verdict: Must-listen—comprehensive 2026 playbook across politics, business, assets

Aspect	Rating
Signal density	★★★★☆
Actionability	★★★★☆
Novel insights	★★★★☆
Production quality	★★★★☆

Best for: Macro investors, tech/VC community, political observers **Skip if:** Want single-thesis deep dive; prefer non-US focus

Key Quotes

1. > *"I think the lower bound is five. I think the upper bound is 6.2%. If we print six, the only country that has printed six is China with complete coordination. The fact we can do it under democracy and capitalism is outrageous."*
2. > *"The way they calculate the value of your stock is not based on its liquid market value but if you own super voting shares they multiply your ownership by the market cap. So for Larry and Sergey, the 5% tax becomes more like a 25% tax."*
3. > *"We are on a path by 2040 where we will be short about 70% of the global supply of copper at current course and speed. The asset set up to go absolutely parabolic is copper."*
4. > *"I think these state governments are going to have a real problem with financing. When these unrealized pension liabilities numbers start to come out, folks are going to wake up and be like holy, there's a ginormous hole."*
5. > *"The software industrial complex—these $3-4 trillion in maintenance and migration revenue will shrink aggressively. Our entire 8090 business has basically migrated to disrupting maintenance and migration patterns."*
6. > *"AI will increase demand for knowledge workers, not decrease it. Jevons paradox—as the cost of a resource goes down, aggregate demand actually increases because you discover more use cases."*
7. > *"I don't think SpaceX will IPO. I think it will reverse merge into Tesla and Elon will use it to consolidate control of his two seminal assets into one cap table."*
8. > *"Atlanta Fed's GDP now model estimate for Q4 2025 is 5.4%—significant jump from 2.7% on January 5th. US productivity just surged 4.9%, the strongest reading in nearly 6 years."*

1) Executive Dashboard (PM Read)

Metric	Assessment
Net Signal	`Bullish US Growth / Cautious Tech-Politics`
Conviction	`High` (GDP/productivity) / `Medium` (sector calls)
Time Horizon	`Cyclical (12m)` predictions
Primary Domain(s)	`Equities` `Commodities` `Politics`
Why Now?	Q4 GDP 5.4%; productivity 4.9%; tax cuts + immigration + AI = growth inflection; CA wealth tax April decision

Top 3 Investable Ideas:

1. **Long copper** — 70% global supply deficit by 2040; critical for data centers, chips, weapons; structural shortage
2. **Long IPOs/capital markets equities** — $250B IG issuance in January; SpaceX/Stripe/Anthropic/OpenAI filing; trillions in new market cap
3. **Short enterprise SaaS (maintenance/migration)** — AI disrupting $3-4T/year spend; per-seat pricing model broken; Chamath's 8090 business exploiting

2) Key Investable Insights

Insight 1: 5-6% GDP Growth—Coiled Spring

- **Claim:** Closed border + AI productivity threat + tax cuts = GDP prints 5-6% in 2026; Atlanta Fed already at 5.4% for Q4 2025
- **Asset Class:** US Equities, Macro
- **Mechanism:** Non-farm payrolls rebased to 40-50 (from 100-150) due to immigration; lower quartile earnings "off the charts"; productivity 4.9% (6-year high)
- **Expression:** Long US equities broadly; favor cyclicals and capital equipment (accelerated depreciation beneficiaries)
- **Trigger to Exit/Flip:** Immigration policy reverses; AI productivity disappoints; recession indicators
- **Confidence:** High

Insight 2: Copper Parabolic Setup

- **Claim:** 70% global supply deficit by 2040; most useful conductive material for AI infrastructure, weapons, electrification
- **Asset Class:** Commodities
- **Mechanism:** Trump doctrine = unilateral national security = critical minerals priority; copper in data centers, chips, weapons; structural shortage
- **Expression:** Long copper futures, miners; basket of critical metals
- **Trigger to Exit/Flip:** Demand destruction; substitute materials emerge; massive new supply
- **Confidence:** High

Insight 3: Enterprise SaaS Disruption (Maintenance/Migration)

- **Claim:** AI agents disrupting $3-4T/year enterprise software spend; 90% of revenue is maintenance/migration, not new licenses
- **Asset Class:** Tech Equities
- **Mechanism:** LLMs can handle mundane maintenance/migration at fraction of cost; per-seat pricing model broken with flat/shrinking headcount; upstarts gaining
- **Expression:** Short legacy SaaS (ServiceNow -30%, Workday -18%, DocuSign -23% in 2025); long AI-native software disruptors
- **Trigger to Exit/Flip:** Legacy vendors successfully pivot to AI; headcount growth resumes
- **Confidence:** Medium-High

Insight 4: Jevons Paradox for Knowledge Workers

- **Claim:** AI will increase demand for knowledge workers, not decrease—as cost of resource falls, aggregate demand rises
- **Asset Class:** Labor Economics, Tech Adoption
- **Mechanism:** Code generation cost down = more software created; radiology scans up despite AI because cost down = more scans; new use cases emerge
- **Expression:** Stay long human-AI hybrid businesses; skeptical of "AI replaces all workers" thesis
- **Trigger to Exit/Flip:** Widespread unemployment data contradicts; AI plateau without new use cases
- **Confidence:** Medium

3) Transmission & Cross-Asset Map

Primary Driver	Direct Impact (1st Order)	Spillover (2nd Order)	Correlation Risk	Funding/Carry Impact	Positioning/ Flows
Immigration + AI productivity	GDP 5-6%; lower quartile wages up	Consumer spending reaccelerates	Growth-rates correlation	Tax cuts add stimulus	Coiled spring thesis
Copper shortage	Copper parabolic	Mining equities, infrastructure	Commodities-growth correlation	N/A	Critical metals basket
CA wealth tax	Half trillion exits state	CA luxury real estate crash; TX/ FL benefit	Political-wealth correlation	N/A	Rush for exits if ballot passes
Enterprise SaaS disruption	Legacy SaaS declines	AI-native upstarts gain	Tech rotation	N/A	Maintenance/ migration disrupted
IPO wave	Trillions new market cap	Liquidity absorption; public markets deepen	Growth-rates correlation	Capital markets wide open	SpaceX/Stripe/ Anthropic filing

4) Regime & Scenario Analysis

- **Current Regime Fit:** Early-cycle boom. Tax cuts + productivity + immigration = growth inflection. M&A/IPOs reopening. Political uncertainty on wealth taxes creates state-level divergence.
- **Base Case (55%):** GDP 5%+; IPO wave materializes; copper rises 30%+; CA wealth tax fails or narrowly passes with legal challenge; SaaS disruption accelerates; tech-politics tension persists.
- **Alt Case 1 (30%):** GDP disappoints 3-4%; IPO window closes; CA wealth tax passes and triggers exodus; recession risk rises late 2026.
- **Alt Case 2 (15%):** Meltup—6%+ GDP; SpaceX IPO at $1T+; copper doubles; full Trump boom realized; Democrats collapse further.
- **Anti-Thesis Trigger:** Inflation resurges forcing Fed hikes; recession materializes; CA wealth tax fails by large margin; AI productivity disappoints.
- **Tail Risks:** China-Taiwan escalation. Oil spike. Pension crisis in multiple states. Tech regulatory crackdown despite Trump.

5) Hard Data & Verifiable Claims

- **Data:** Atlanta Fed GDP Now Q4 2025: 5.4% (up from 2.7% on Jan 5)
- **Data:** US productivity: 4.9% (6-year high)
- **Data:** CPI 2.7%, Core CPI 2.6% (40bps below expectations)
- **Data:** Q3 2025 GDP: 4.3%
- **Data:** Lowest trade deficit since 2009
- **Data:** Challenger Gray job cuts down 50% from November
- **Data:** Mortgage costs down $3,000
- **Data:** Real wages up $1,000
- **Data:** Ford paying mechanics $160K/year with 5,000 openings
- **Data:** IG issuance: $250B projected for January (2x 10-year average)
- **Data:** ServiceNow -30%, Workday -18%, DocuSign -23% in 2025
- **Data:** Half trillion net worth already left California
- **Data:** Copper 70% supply deficit by 2040 (Chamath claim)
- **Data:** Poly market CA wealth tax: 69% to make ballot
- **Claim:** Sergey/Larry each have ~52% combined voting power of Google
- **Claim:** Non-farm payrolls rebased from 100-150 to 40-50 prints

6) BS & Bias Filter

- **Incentives:** All four are wealthy Californians directly affected by wealth tax. Sacks in Trump administration. Chamath runs 8090 (SaaS disruption bet). All have VC portfolios benefiting from IPO wave.
- **Blind Spots:** US-centric; limited international perspective. Optimistic on Trump policies. Dismissive of California's ability to adapt. Limited recession scenario analysis.
- **Track Record:** 2025 predictions: Freeberg nailed Chinese tech (+85% Alibaba), Gavin nailed Micron (+230%). Mixed on others.
- **Consensus Check:** 5-6% GDP = above consensus (bullish). Copper = contrarian. SaaS disruption = emerging consensus. Jevons paradox = contrarian to AI job loss narrative.
- **Sample Bias:** Tech/VC lens. Wealthy perspective on taxes. Limited labor/consumer voice.

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7) PM Bottom Line

Action → Trade + Monitor

Long copper and critical metals basket—structural shortage confirmed, 70% deficit by 2040. Long capital markets beneficiaries (exchanges, brokers) into IPO wave. Short legacy enterprise SaaS—per-seat model broken, maintenance/migration being disrupted. Stay long US equities broadly—5%+ GDP, 4.9% productivity, tax cuts. Monitor CA wealth tax April ballot decision—if passes, expect luxury real estate crash and accelerated exits. Watch for SpaceX/Stripe/Anthropic/OpenAI IPO filings. Jevons paradox lens on AI employment fears—don't assume job destruction.

Key watches: CA signature gathering (April). Atlanta Fed GDP prints. IPO filings from unicorns. Copper inventories. Enterprise SaaS earnings guidance. State pension liability disclosures. Tech-politics reconciliation meetings.